description you added in the previous sections. You'll learn how to generate your client, customize the generated code, and rebuild the client when your app's OpenAPI description changes.

Finally, in section 11.5, you'll learn more ways to add metadata to your endpoints to give the best experience for your generated clients. You'll learn how to add summaries and descriptions to your endpoints by using method calls and attributes and by extracting the XML documentation comments from your C# code.

Before we consider those advanced scenarios, we'll look at the OpenAPI specification, what it is, and how you can add an OpenAPI document to your app.

11.1 Adding an OpenAPI description to your app

OpenAPI (previously called Swagger) is a language-agnostic specification for describing RESTful APIs. At its core, OpenAPI describes the schema of a JavaScript Object Notation (JSON) document which in turn describes the URLs available in your application, how to invoke them, and the data types they return. In this section you'll learn how to generate an OpenAPI document for your minimal API application.

Providing an OpenAPI document for your application makes it possible to add various types of automation for your app. You can do the following things, for example:

- Explore your app using Swagger UI (section 11.2).
- Generate strongly-typed clients for interacting with your app (section 11.4).
- Automatically integrate into third-party services such as Azure API Management.